

Access Points

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Access points

Leamer Objective: *Learn about wireless access points in modern wireless networks of today*

Description: In this episode, you will learn about wireless access points. You will learn about the key differences between autonomous access points and lightweight access points.

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- Wireless Access Points (WAPs) are devices that enable wireless communication between client devices (such as laptops, smartphones, and tablets) and a wired network.
 - WAPs play a crucial role in providing wireless connectivity within a specific area, often referred to as a Wi-Fi network.
 - Access points act as a bridge between the wired and wireless networks, facilitating the transmission of data between devices.
 - There are two main categories of wireless access points: lightweight access points (LWAPs) and autonomous access points (APs). These categories refer to the management and control mechanisms of the access points.
 - Autonomous Access Points (APs) - autonomous access points operate independently and do not require a central controller to manage them. Each autonomous AP is configured individually, and they make local decisions regarding channel selection, security settings, and network management. While autonomous APs are easy to set up and manage individually, they may become challenging to scale and maintain in large, complex networks.
 - Lightweight Access Points (LWAPs) - lightweight access points are designed to work in conjunction with a central controller in a wireless LAN (Local Area Network). The central controller is responsible for managing and coordinating the activities of multiple lightweight APs, providing a centralized point for configuration, monitoring, and control. LWAPs are often preferred in larger and more complex wireless networks because they offer centralized management, making it easier to implement consistent policies and configurations across the network.
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Additional Resources:

Wireless Access Points

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wireless_access_point